

Stercorarius longicaudus

Long-tailed jaeger

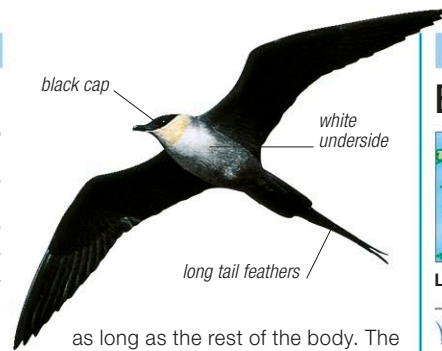


Length 19–21 in
(48–53 cm)
Weight 8–13 oz
(225–350 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Migrant
Status Least concern

Location Circumpolar around Arctic and Antarctica



This gray and black jaeger differs from other skuas in having very long central tail feathers, which are clearly visible when it flies. These feathers may be half



as long as the rest of the body. The long-tailed jaeger undertakes one of the longest of all bird migrations—from the Arctic to the southern oceans. Lemmings constitute its diet on land, whereas it feeds on fish and robs other birds while at sea.

Pagophila eburnea

Ivory gull



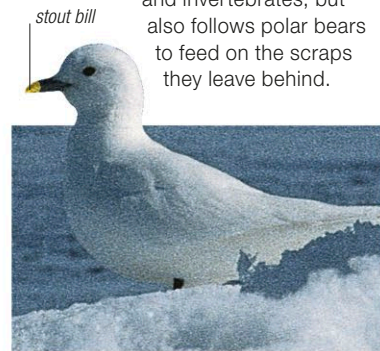
Length 17½–19 in
(44–48 cm)
Weight 19–25 oz
(525–700 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Partial migrant
Status Near threatened

Location Almost circumpolar around Arctic



The gull family contains about 50 species, about 35 of which are found in the Northern Hemisphere. Many are familiar birds—both on coasts and

inland—but the ivory gull is much less well known. Its entire life is spent in the high Arctic, mostly on the edge of pack ice. This gull feeds chiefly on fish and invertebrates, but also follows polar bears to feed on the scraps they leave behind.

*Larus argentatus*

European herring gull



Length 22–26 in
(55–67 cm)
Weight 1½–3¼ lb
(0.73–1.5 kg)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Partial migrant
Status Least concern

Location Europe



The European herring gull, like its close relatives in North America and Asia, is a common coastal bird, and is familiar inland, too, especially in winter. Numbers grew rapidly during the last century in response to increased feeding opportunities at garbage dumps, landfill sites, sewage outflows, and other places where it can forage opportunistically. Adaptability is the key to its success, and it eats almost anything edible, including eggs and chicks of other birds, but numbers have recently begun to decline. It is very vocal, especially in spring, when adults return to the same site to breed year after year. Herring gulls in America have been split as a separate species, American herring gull, as have those in northeast Asia, such as the Vega gull.

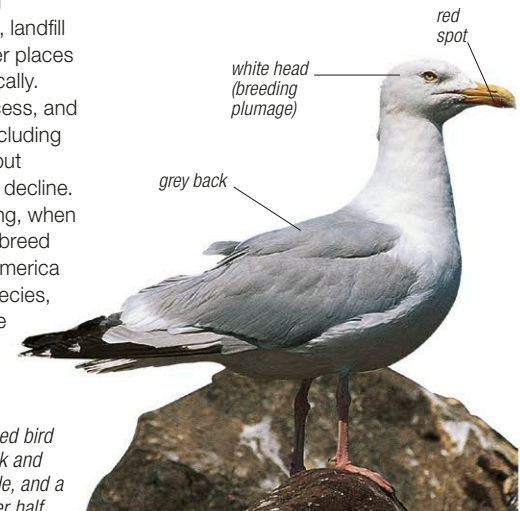
GRAY ADULT

One of the larger gulls, this pink-legged bird has a gray back and wings, with black and white tips, a white head and underside, and a yellow bill with a red spot on the lower half.



JUVENILE

Young herring gulls have brown-streaked feathers and take 4 years to acquire adult plumage.

*Larus dominicanus*

Kelp gull



Length 21½–26 in
(54–65 cm)
Weight 2–3¼ lb
(0.9–1.5 kg)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Partial migrant
Status Least concern

Location South America, Antarctica, southern Africa, S. Australia, New Zealand



This large coastal bird is one of the most widespread gulls south of the equator. Its back and wings are black, while the head, tail, and underside are white. Its large, yellow bill has a red spot on the lower half. This opportunistic feeder catches invertebrates stirred up by whales, steals food from terns, and kills birds as large as geese. It also feeds on termite swarms, and scavenges at fish factories and slaughterhouses.

Chlidonias niger

Black tern

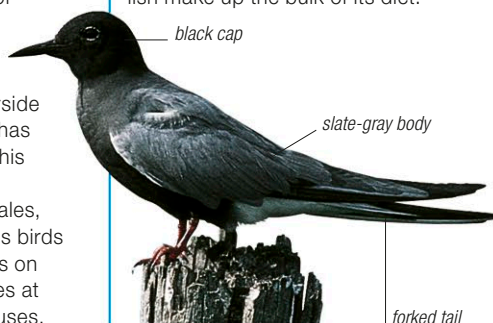


Length 9–11 in
(22–28 cm)
Weight 2½–2¾ oz
(60–75 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Migrant
Status Least concern

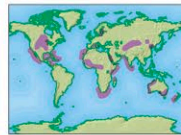
Location North and Central America, N. South America, Europe to C. Asia, Africa



Terns are graceful birds, with slender bodies and forked tails. Most of them are white with a black cap, but the black tern has dark plumage. Unlike most terns, it does not breed on the coast, but on inland lakes, marshes, and bogs. Here, it feeds mainly on insects plucked from plants, off the water surface, or caught on the wing. Out of the breeding season, when back in coastal waters, small marine fish make up the bulk of its diet.

*Hydroprogne caspia*

Caspian tern



Length 19–22 in
(48–56 cm)
Weight 21–28 oz
(575–775 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Partial migrant
Status Least concern

Location North to Central America, Europe, Africa, Asia, Australia, New Zealand

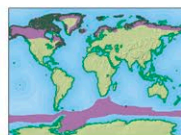


With a wingspan of up to 4½ ft (1.4 m), this is the largest species of tern, approaching the size of larger gulls. It spends winter on lakes, coasts,

and estuaries, and in the breeding season is likely to be found in freshwater habitats. It catches fish by plunge-diving, swallowing them head-first while in flight.

*Sterna paradisaea*

Arctic tern



Length 13–14 in
(33–35 cm)
Weight 3¾–4 oz
(95–125 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Migrant
Status Least concern

Location Arctic, N. North America, Antarctica



The Arctic tern makes one of the longest migrations of any bird—a journey of at least 10,000 miles (16,000 km), twice a year. Each autumn, it flies from its

nesting place in the north to Antarctica for the southern summer, making the most of the daylight in both hemispheres. It probably spends more time in daylight than any other creature. It feeds mainly on fish, hovering then plunge-diving, or dipping into the water.

